

WINNER VERSUS LOSER; INTERPLAY BETWEEN THE SELF AND CREATIVE FORCES

Greetings, my dearest friends. God bless every one of you. Blessed be this lecture. Let us proceed tonight with a lecture which is a direct continuation of the series begun at our last session.

Last time, we discussed the arbitrary either/or concepts that all human beings harbor. They are the very fences that hold you imprisoned. Now I wish to discuss one of the greatest limitations, one of the most common, overall either/or concepts. It is an attitude toward life of winning versus losing. According to this concept, it is felt that being a winner means ruthlessness, selfishness, trampling and triumphing over others, belittling them. There is no room for consideration, kindness, sympathy. If these emotions are allowed, becoming a loser is the feared result. Being a loser is supposed to mean unselfishness, sacrifice, goodness, kindness, consideration. Both sides contain the identical misconception. Some adopt the one alternative, some the other. Each fears the consequences of the other side of his choice. Neither one of the two choices is "better" or "worse" than the other. Both end up with the identical results of loneliness, resentment, self-pity, self-contempt, frustration.

When two people are involved in a close relationship, each having adopted the opposing choice with both representing the same wrong conclusion from the two sides, such a relationship must be fraught with friction to the point of hopelessness. Each resents in the other what he fears and fights in himself. The winner fears his impulses of genuine affection as much as his weakness and desire for dependency. The loser fears his resentments, his selfish impulses because he not only strives for goodness according to false, limited concepts, to rigid outer regulations, but also his private pseudosolution may be a need for total approval from others. He may be unable to stand any form of criticism even if it is unjustified. What these two resent most in the other is their own hidden tendency to the opposite side of their choice.

Most human beings have at least some measure of this false concept. Some experience it as a general overall climate toward life, others only in certain areas. It is a vague feeling which, if translated into concise words, means, "I cannot have what I want, I must lose," or "In order not to lose, I must be tough and disregarding of others." The latter is convinced of losing too unless he sacrifices his need for human warmth, appreciation, and love. This is an expensive price to pay even if it were true that then he could win. But just because he never allows himself to relax, to let his guards go, to let go in general, he cannot experience that this is a false idea. He believes that perhaps he has a chance to win, provided he cripples his very being. Since in this way he certainly cannot win, his negativity increases, and he begins to doubt himself, his strength, his adequacy.

It is of great importance in this phase of the pathwork to detect this subtle climate you exude, in which you assume, anticipate, and therefore fight in an unproductive way against losing, or resign

to it. Do you feel you have to be the cruel one in order not to be the poor, stupid one? Or do you resign to the latter, priding yourself on your decency while merely not daring to defy the world and the rules which seem to decree that goodness means deprivation? In both attitudes, guilt and uncertainty are inevitable. The one alternative makes strenuous demands on the self that are not only impossible to realize but destructive for all concerned. The other makes demands upon the world and on others to reward the self for the happiness he sacrificingly forsakes. Since he does not allow himself to go out and obtain his own fulfillment, others must obtain it for him as a reward for his self-sacrifice, for his "goodness." This demand cannot be fulfilled.

This concept is tragically wrong. It is so unnecessary to make two such poor choices. It is tragic because what man deeply believes must appear to be true by dint of his behaving according to this belief. As you know from all images, they always appear to be confirmed in their wrong conclusions. When man sacrifices human decency in order to gain his rights and fulfillments or if he sacrifices the latter in order to gain the former, in both instances he must lose both.

The limitation of believing that only one of these two alternatives exists is wrong because it is indeed possible to assert your rights, to reach out to obtain what you wish without being cruel or without depriving anyone of anything. In fact, it is necessary to reach out for what you want. But being convinced of the limited wrong conclusion must make you feel guilty when you do reach out for what you wish. Hence, a subtle no-current barricades the way.

By the same token, it is possible occasionally to forfeit your own immediate advantage for the sake of a loved one without forever giving up all your rights and all your advantages. It is indeed possible to say yes to your own happiness without saying no to consideration of others. The more you are convinced, on all levels of your being, of this truth, the less conflict will be encountered between the advantages of the self and those of others. The more you embrace the reality and widen your horizon, the more do you break through a particular fence which sees reality as much harder and harsher than it actually is. The two choices available truly shed a dismal light on life. Both choices are poor ones; the decision is therefore impossible. Neither alternative is preferable. To discover that this choice does not have to be made means incredible liberation -- liberation from guilt, from unhappiness, from frustration, from helplessly waiting for something that others can never produce for the self, from weakness and dependency, from the need to belittle and triumph over others. When this widened outlook on life opens up and is assimilated by your innermost consciousness, peace and certainty must fill you.

For some of you, my friends, it is possible to feel the subtle climate of this atmosphere -- this most hidden atmosphere of this either/or. Extended progress on your path has brought you face to face with this climate you emanate. It is a very distinct, very definite atmosphere, filling your whole being. Nevertheless, it is not immediately noticeable upon beginning such a path. It is not immediately accessible to your awareness unless you have explored the depths of your innermost self.

When you have reached this awareness and find certain areas in you in which you take this limitation for granted -- the inevitable hopelessness that winning or obtaining fulfillment is impossible -- you will clearly understand why you are unfulfilled in certain areas, or why you have difficulties, and why it is so hard and so fraught with anxiety and tension. It is this very negative, false idea that creates the hardship. Bring out into the open how you are influenced by such a false

concept of life. Translate your emotional reactions in this respect into concise words. Analyze their significance, and then compare the result with reality the way you know and have experienced it in other areas of living where you are healthier and fulfilled in your outlook.

Coming face to face with this climate, this inner expectancy of life, is a climactic step in the evolution of an individual. The full realization of the limited outlook, its significance and effect, signify a major inner transition. The result of this transition is the giving up of this limited choice. It means knowing the truth that one does not exclude the other, that both love and self-assertion are possible -- nay, interdependent. You can then envisage the many other choices in any given issue. You will then see how the truth in this respect always existed. That is, that reaching out for what should be yours without hesitancy and guilt and, at the same time, opening yourself up for the other person, no longer appear as contradictions. In fact, you must then experience that the more you open yourself up for your own fulfillment, the more you embrace the fulfillments of others, being willing to grant and give it to them. Conversely, the less you feel you deserve fulfillment yourself, closing yourself up to it due to false concepts, the more you automatically prevent the fulfillments of others. You then must deprive others to give fulfillment to yourself. For how can you give of something that you feel you have no right to have and care for? After this particular transition, you once again experience the great truth that does away with mutual exclusiveness. From an either/or, you change into a consciousness of fullness and inclusiveness.

My advice is to examine this in you as a general concept about life as well as in specific areas of your personality. Man's tendency to escape reality is often based not on the fact that he cannot face unpleasant aspects of it, but just as often, on a deeper level, that he fears happiness, fulfillment, fullness of living. In order to realize personal expansion and self-expression, with its concomitant bliss, it is necessary to tap one's own inner resources, to find the well of divine strength deep within the psyche -- with all its truth and love. But this seems such an impossible and dangerous undertaking for many that they pretend rather that life is dismal and hopeless, thereby clinging to others to sustain and save them rather than forfeit this false salvation. They can then flatter themselves that they are realistic. It often appears more realistic to accept suffering and pain rather than to allow for constructive living and the possibility for happiness. This is all too often regarded as unrealism. It is so much harder to face for many that life could be all-embracing, meaningful, and beautiful because it requires the courage to look at the truth within the self.

To the degree that truth is faced and understood, you become a creator, a creator of your own life, thereby continuing the creative process of the universe. There is no limit as to how far you can go in expressing beauty, wisdom, happiness, fulfillment, productivity -- for yourself and for others. To the degree that you liberate yourself from such either/or concepts, to that degree does fear give way to truth, to that degree do you expand. Your whole inner psychic life processes reach out. Your individuality stretches and expresses the potential beauty that life is. Your readiness and preparedness to express the dynamic process of life in its marvel and bliss must make the marvel and bliss a reality, for you are then receptive to truth.

In order to realize this, it is important to understand and express the proper balance between the self and universal powers constantly at work in any creative process. How do they interact with the self? To what extent is the self engaged? To what extent are universal powers engaged? This equilibrium is essential for the creative process to take place whether this means the creation of a living being, the creation of art, science, or the creation of a relationship, or the creation of the

particular manner, style, and atmosphere of your personal fate. All of these are creative processes and require the creative powers. Wherever creation takes place, universal powers must be at work.

Man is often confused in this respect. He somehow knows or senses that without these creative powers nothing of value can come into existence. On the other hand, every enlightened philosophy teaches him that he is the master of his fate; that he must create his life according to his inclination; that happiness or unhappiness is the result of his personality, his beliefs, his attitudes and concepts. Again, he is confronted with an either/or. He believes that he must make a choice between either disregarding these creative powers and merely trusting his outer mind and will, which cannot get him very far. Or he does not trust himself at all, externalizing the universal powers into an outer deity, which must let him down. Both alternatives are disappointing because they are the result of misunderstanding, exclusiveness, limitation with the further result of being unable to either trust the self or God. The balance between the proper interplay between self-directing mind and creative universal powers is upset the moment it becomes a question of one versus the other.

In order to comprehend the proper balance, it is necessary to understand the function of both. The part the self has to play is to want the right, constructive thing. I do not speak about this in moralistic terms. It may be any simple, human fulfillment that man deeply yearns for and is supposed to experience if he were not conditioned to believe that personal happiness is selfish or extracts from him a price he is incapable of paying or which seems not worthwhile. Any basic happiness must further not only self-expression, expansion, and the manifestation of the divine, but must do so also for others around such an individual. If man manifests his inherent potential, everything and everyone he comes in contact with must be positively and constructively affected. The more intense the contact, the greater is the effect. This applies to happiness in every form, not just in some forms.

A superficial wanting is not enough. Taking for granted that you want it because it seems the obvious thing is not enough. Leaving the desire in a hazy, unformulated fog is not enough. All unconscious countercurrents for whatever misconception must be dislodged. I have often said that the more tense and strenuous your desire, the more an unconscious countercurrent must exist. Truly and relaxedly wanting the desirable result can only happen when you find and remove unconscious reservations, limitations, doubts, and opposite desires. If you fear not obtaining the desired result, you must somehow and somewhere within your psyche fear the desired result. Finding this contradiction means great liberation and a giant step closer to the fulfillment.

You may ask why you should fear happiness. For example, you may fear the abandonment to it, that the bliss makes you lose control over the self. You may fear the obligation accruing from it. Or you may fear your inadequacy to obtain or maintain it. Obviously wanting a goal does not exclude the fact that unconsciously something says no. So when I say that the self's part in the mutual interplay between it and creative powers is the wholehearted wanting it, it is not always as simple as this sounds. How it is wanted, what soul movements accompany this wanting -- all this has to be determined. In order to get to this point, two factors are necessary. One is exploring your most subtle reactions in this respect -- where and why you say no to what you want most. And you must know that you say no if the result remains unrealized. The second factor is to express in so many words, with your whole being, that this is what you want. Observe your inner reflexes as you do so. Are you relaxed when you so express it? Or are you tense and fearful? Are you confident or are you distrustful? Do you assume that it is possible, or do you assume that it is impossible? If you

can give yourself the truthful answers to these questions by observing your soul movements, you are closer to eliminating the obstructions than when you ignore them and believe yourself free from any countercurrents.

Apart from this relaxed, whole-wanting, without urgency, compulsion, tension, and fear, it is necessary for the self to know the truth, as we discussed in the lecture pertaining to that subject. In this particular context, the meaning would be this. If you wish a particular fulfillment and do not have it -- whether it be an overall issue like success in a career, health, a fruitful mutuality, good friends, the liberation from an inner problem, or a link in the chain toward attaining any of these results, the finding and dissolving of obstructions, of attitudes that hinder you -- you must know that experiencing the fulfillment is within the scheme of creation; that it is good and right for all concerned; that there is not only nothing destructive or wrong about it, but that it is good and right. You must contemplate its effects on yourself and others from every conceivable point of view so as to convince yourself that your wishing and striving for it is constructive. You must see that every generalization you assumed as to why it was not supposed to be so (perhaps due to an imagined or real mass image with its prohibitions) bears no justification, logic, or meaning. This conviction will strengthen your desire, will make it free from reservation. It will remove false guilt due to which you choose deprivation. It will make it possible to firmly declare that you wish to have it, that you know it depends on you, and that you not only wish it but know that you are going to have it. And you must have it in the measure that you remove doubt and negativity. Declare that its results must be beneficial for yourself and for others. Visualize how this will be so. Strengthen your will to remove all obstructions within yourself, all false ideas that keep you fenced in. To the degree that you are relaxed and decided in such a declaration, do you approach the fulfillment; to that degree do you fulfill your end of the bargain; to that degree do you automatically set the creative powers in motion. This must produce results, and those results give you the justification to entrust yourself to this entire creative process. You trust your ability to fulfill your end of it, and you trust these powers to do theirs. To the degree that you trust both, must you reap the fruits. The more you trust, the more results, so that you have better reason to trust. A benign circle is set in motion.

Moreover, it is necessary for the self to summon, deliberately and consciously, the universal, creative forces not only to help, guide, and inspire you to fulfill your part of the partnership, to remove all obstructions and reservations, but to make the thing, whatever it is, grow. These powers can be set in motion only by consciousness. Man has the choice of letting it happen automatically, letting his unconscious attitude affect the creative life force, or he can deliberately pronounce the direction in which he wants them to work. The self-directing mind sets the universal forces in motion. They respond according to the direction set by consciousness. Once this is done, once the personality fulfills the necessary conditions, it has nothing further to do with the creative process. They take over and know exactly what to do in any given instant.

In this light, it is clear that it is not a contradiction when you hear that you are responsible for your fate and that powers beyond your scope and resourcefulness must complete the creative process. This same principle exists all over. For example, compare yourself with a gardener. He must prepare the soil, but he does not make the plant grow. Preparing your own consciousness amounts to the gardener preparing the soil. Eliminating wrong concepts amounts to the gardener removing weeds. Removing your blocks amounts to removing rocks in the soil that hinder the spreading of the roots and later the plants. Implanting truthful concepts amounts to planting the seeds. Cultivating the proper attitude and patiently waiting until it has taken root and can

subsequently sprout its fruits, amounts to the gardener tending the soil, seeing that it has sufficient light, moisture, nourishment. The gardener thus fulfills his job, thereby calling the creative process into existence, making it possible for it to take place. But it is not the gardener who possesses the ability to make a tree out of a seed, or a fruit or flower. If he wants a particular plant, he must sow the particular seed, but it is not up to him to finish the growth. There is nothing in the world he can do to actually bring it about that the seed develops into the plant. A creative process is at work that definitely requires his cooperation. Certain conditions he alone can fulfill, but this is where it ends. He then lets nature do its job.

Man often wishes for a specific result, but what he sows in his consciousness is the seed for a very opposite result. He then distrusts life. If he sees how he brings forth exactly what he sows, even the previous negative results, due to negative causes, must strengthen his confidence in the principle of the creative process.

The same principle prevails with the healing process of the body. When you cut your skin, you have to wash the wound so that no dirt can cause poisoning and prevent the healing process to take place. So you tend the wound to help the healing forces to take their course.

When you regard any creative process, on the physical, mental, or spiritual level, you must find the same principle, the same interrelationship. There always is a period of growth, its duration depending on the kind of seed planted. It is the same with the mind level. When you plant a seed of an outcome that your innermost self cannot quite accept, or where powerful countercurrents have existed for a considerable time, the period of incubation, of quiet growth beneath the surface, is longer than when you plant something that your consciousness is ready for and prepared for. It is often that man despairs and ceases to trust because he ignores the period of growth. Thereby he tears out the seed he has planted.

This mutual interaction between the self and the creative forces sets a perfect balance between activity of the self (fulfilling all the enumerated conditions) and passivity (letting the universal powers do their work, entrusting the self to them), in a full letting go of the self, in a total commitment to them.

When you find the right balance of that, there will be no fulfillment missing in your life. There will be harmony in your soul. You will not be overactive, on the one hand, by thinking you have to do it all, nor will you be overly passive by entrusting yourself to a false, externalized God, who is supposed to do the work for you. In the proper balance, there is perfect activity in a relaxed, unstrained, stimulating, harmonious way. There is perfect self-responsibility and the recognition that you are the master of your life, that it depends on you, on how you prepare the soil. There will also be the proper sense of limitation to your functions and powers, the humility to entrust the self to powers that are beyond the confines of the self. This enlarges the self and its powers because it uses the life force as it is meant to be used. This means proper knowing of creation, which constantly takes place within you and around you.

You set the creative process in motion in a most marvelous way when you know that the perfect possibility exists as a potential and therefore as a still unrealized fact. This knowing makes possible that it be realized. This knowing makes it possible to allow the creative powers to enter into you by removing a wall of doubt, fear, ignorance. There comes a point when you actually feel

and experience this wall and you can slide it away, thereby opening yourself for creation with its manifold possibilities. This act is first feared, later tentatively tried, and then experienced as the key to selfhood. The self is gained by not avoiding accountability and by letting go of the tight mind, in committing and giving yourself over fully.

Usually a reverse situation exists. The self is lazy, does not want to assume the necessary responsibility or accountability, does not do what must be done in order to obtain a desirable result in order to lead a meaningful existence. Where activity should reign, passivity exists. And where the self must let go and allow cosmic intelligence to produce, activity is maintained, the self is being busy, distrusting, and holding itself together in a tight knot.

When the individual reestablishes this balance, fences dissolve. The expansion of the self becomes truly limitless. It will be as limitless as you know the universe to be limitless. You can realize these limitless potentials. This is a truth. This is not wishful thinking. It is not evading the self.

When you meditate, my friends, and embrace a truthful concept, first in the outer regions of your mind by removing the underlying obstructions and no-currents, gradually this knowing the truth spreads into the more inner layers of your being so that your psyche, like a beautiful flower, unfolds into the rays of the sun. As each layer is soaked through with truth, it is nourished by it with a new vitality flowing through the organism. In hours of deep recognition, this can be distinctly felt. Where you were first tightly laced in, you open up to the liberation and light that the infusion of truth always brings about.

Are there any questions? Is everything I said clear?

QUESTION: In my mind it is clear, and yet it is not really clear. This was always my trouble, and I can't understand it. For instance, the seed is put into the earth, and everything is prepared. The seed will come out without the prayer. I've heard and read that when one prays over plants, they come out better than those plants one leaves alone. So, when I plant into my subconscious what I really want, I still feel that it can't come out. Even if I feel that I can do it, deep inside I feel that it can't come out. My doubt makes me feel that I cannot do it even when I enlist the universal forces.

ANSWER: You feel yourself a loser to begin with. In the first place, let me make you understand what prayer really means. It means a straightening out of your own consciousness as well as of your unconscious attitudes, concepts, thoughts, and feelings. The truly integrated spirit would not need to pray or meditate. Every breath would be a prayer in that it would be an expression of his entire personality, which is at one with truth, love, purposefulness, creation -- with all the universal forces which would inevitably flow through him in a most constructive way. Prayer means shaping a loose mass of hazy thoughts and concepts, of contradictory emotions. It means impregnating the self with truth so that the individual knows the truth. Hence, the universal forces can automatically flow through this consciousness.

As to your doubt, it is important for you to establish the fact that you are afraid of giving up the doubt. Needless to say, this is due to a wrong conclusion. But there is a very distinct reason that you feel threatened, truly endangered without the doubt. It is as though doubt is an

indispensable weapon for you. By battling the doubt in the direct way you have tried, you will hardly succeed because you are too afraid of letting go of it. It is necessary to establish (1) that you fear to give up the doubt, (2) to establish the specific wrong conclusion as to why you do so. Ask yourself in your meditations, "Why do I want to doubt? What is it that I fear would happen if I have no doubt?"

Moreover, it will also help -- all of my friends, because it is general -- to realize that doubt is held onto because commitment is feared. Some of my friends have begun to find this out in their personal work. But the whole extent of such a fear must be more profoundly understood with all its consequences. Committing and entrusting oneself to the universal powers (as well as to any person or cause) is feared because disappointment is taken for granted. So the individual plays a game with himself. He acts as though he believes in a possibility of a favorable outcome, but does not really. He doubts such a possibility so strongly that he is not even willing to take a chance of testing or risking it. His doubt means "I pretend a maybe, but I am convinced of a certain no, which I am unwilling to face so that I can go on pretending." In this way, the fallacy of the no, as well as of the maybe, can never be proved. The person remains perpetually in a "temporary state" on the fringes of being and living. He never settles down to serious living, to confronting any issue wholly and truthfully. He continuously dabbles in theory rather than making the one step where theory is put into practice.

Commitment is such an important topic regarding anything. For you will get out of life exactly as much as you commit yourself to, whether this means shaping and creating your life by committing yourself to the universal forces to cooperate with you, whether this means to an undertaking or to a person or to a relationship. It makes no difference what it is. If you only commit yourself with reservations, forever watching out that you remain "safe," with strings attached, bargaining and holding back, to exactly that degree will life pay you back. For life cannot be cheated. It is the only thing that really can never be cheated or deceived. And this is where the blind person constantly believes he can "get by." He holds back, hoping that life will give him first a big slice and then, maybe, he is willing to give back a crumb. Many may give much more than is constructive or helpful to others, out of the sole unconscious reason of cheating on life, to get more from it than one is willing to put into and commit oneself for. It does not work that way, my friends.

A wholehearted commitment is so feared because it is falsely believed that it demands giving up your intelligence, your rights, your reason, your self-preservation, your ability to choose, your self-determination. That is not true. It simply means full integrity, direct purpose, no evasions, uncovered motivations, doing the thing for the sake of itself, without subterfuge. It does not mean blind foolishness, and most certainly it does not create helplessness toward abuse. It is quite the contrary. Full commitment presupposes wide-awake choosing, the freedom to do so without compulsion, conflict, or guilt. But such choosing requires to be very much aware. You cannot be a person who is aware if you run away from yourself. For general awareness is the result of self-awareness. So it must begin with the truthful facing of the self, with courageous self-confrontation of the most ingrained emotional reactions. Then awareness of life and others grows concomitantly. And consequently through such awareness, reason, vision, and freedom of choice, commitment is not a hazardous, self-destructive process, not a blind compulsion or drive, but a wonderful extension of self, a reaching out into life and toward others, toward fulfillment of self and of others. That is the real and healthy power resulting from spiritual growth. This is the

self-sufficiency that does not exclude love and deep relating with others. This is the fine point where it is not mutually exclusive to stand firmly and to love, to be self-sufficient and have a healthy interdependency -- be it with the cosmic forces or with other human beings. But the commitment must exist, for otherwise you will be poor and empty. Is that clear?

QUESTION: Yes, it is clear. I have even already found this in my private work regarding commitment. I now know that I have never committed myself really, not to anything, out of fear. But here, I could feel that I can commit myself, but I fear so much that if I do and it does not come out, I am so lost that I do not dare it.

ANSWER: You see, it is exactly what I said. It is exactly the same reason you never dared to commit yourself to anything. And this is precisely the reason you feel unfulfilled in the important areas of your life. But now that you know, see, observe, and understand this, you can not only increase the understanding of this cause and effect, but it is the key to change the course of noncommitment for a new course of commitment.

Your impatience tears out every seed you plant. Because you doubt, you are impatient, too quickly you conclude the results to be negative, thereby not allowing for the necessary time of incubation, or inner, invisible growing underground. The more complicated the problem, the more deep-rooted is the negativity and conflict, the more indirectly do the healing forces have to work from link to link until the final end result can be striven for. For example, when you find doubt, this must first be considered, paid attention to, treated, eliminated, understood in its cause and effect, before you can get to that goal you wish to attain, but cannot attain due to the doubt. When you wish a major fulfillment and it is blocked off by innumerable little misconceptions, they have to be tackled one by one. Otherwise the obstructions are not removed, and working for the end result cannot be successful. This is often overlooked, thereby apparently confirming the doubt.

And now that you know what you have just declared, you can convince yourself of the unreasonableness of maintaining the noncommitment. You are not a prey to it nor to your doubt. It is necessary to take the chance of finding out the truth even if the truth is what you fear it to be. You must love truth above all instead of preferring a "maybe" -- and never coming to terms with life. If you love truth above all else, in this respect as well as in any other, you will also give up impatience. You will go step by step and give it time -- as the scientist who patiently and laboriously researches without shying away from effort, time, tests, trials, and error. He makes up his mind to this procedure. He does not expect the greatest of all truths in a hurry. Do not say you have spent many years on this. I know that. It is not the number of years you have labored in noncommitment and impatience. It is the quality of full commitment with its concomitant patient trying from one link to another. This alone will bring results. Not the years nor the amount of effort can replace full inner commitment. As man often overdoes in giving to others more than is justified while not giving of himself to life, so can he substitute for full commitment a span of suffering, labor, effort, and long years.

The universal forces have but one aim, and that is toward wholeness, health, unfoldment, expression of divine aspects. They strive toward healing where distortion exists, toward making whole and full where disability and emptiness exist. When the obstructions are too great, this same power is diverted and temporarily appears as a destructive power, a downward movement. This does not mean it is another, evil power at work. It is one and the same benign force which was

forced to make a detour of its own course. This growing principle is obvious once it is fully looked at and understood. Then it can be observed at work all over and around you. You will not trust this growing principle any less because it requires a certain time span for the seed to become a tree. It is no different with the matters of mind and spirit.

Try to work with these soul movements, with the concepts I have given you, always and always first finding and removing the misconceptions. Do not superimpose the right concepts, but realize and compare, with your own thinking faculties, what is truth and what is error.

Personal fulfillment, full expansion are waiting for all of you. This is your destiny. Every one of you must sooner or later come to the realization that life is what you think it is, temporarily; and it is what you know it is, ultimately. This means that the potential and possibility, even on this earth sphere, is indescribable happiness. Once this is envisaged, it opens up into its vast and beautiful possibilities.

Be blessed, my dearest friends. Be in peace. Be in God!

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